The easy way

It’s quick. It’s dirty. And you can do it while eating a taco:

Just open another online saver that’s linked to *your* existing bank account.

Nickname the account (e.g. Davin’s Savings Account).

(Fun fact: I was all set to be called Davin—apparently in homage to my mother’s favourite glam rocker heartthrob at the time. That was until my father came home one day and said, ‘Let’s just call him Scott.’ THANK GOD!)

Bonus: doing this with your existing bank means you won’t stuff around opening an account at a different bank.

Extra bonus: you’ll get a higher rate of interest than the majority of those kiddy accounts, and there are no restrictions on withdrawals or amounts.

At the time of writing, the zero-fee, high-interest-earning everyday bank account that I personally use is the ING Orange Everyday account, with a linked Savings Maximiser account. However, you should also have a look at ME Bank and UBank which both have similar offers.

(And, for the record, I have never, ever received a cent for recommending any product. Nothing. Never. Ever.)

That’s my best tip.

However, if you’ve already got an existing bank account for your kids and can’t be arsed changing it, that’s totally okay too.

Whatever gets you through the day without snorting Froot Loops.

Either way, now that you have ‘Davin’s Savings Account’ in place, you’ll have a place to park your kid’s birthday bucks. And as long as they have three jam jars for their pocket money, that savings account is the only bank account they’ll need . . . until they turn 15.

And that’s a nice introduction to teen banking.